

The 6:15

FRIDAY · SEPTEMBER 4, 2026

NO. 10

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Fri 9/4 (today)	Aug. jobs report (NFP), 8:30a ET (BLS) — after this issue's press time. Cons. +53K payrolls (range to +90K across desks), unemployment rate seen holding 4.1%; July's -23K miss (cons. +83K) is the bar.
Sat 9/5	Northwestern opens vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT (Big Ten Network).
Sun 9/6	OPEC+ core-7 meeting; group expected to hold quotas steady through year-end after completing Sept. output-restoration hike (+188K bpd).
Mon 9/7	Labor Day — markets closed.
Tue 9/8	Canada's dollar-for-dollar tariffs on ~\$27.6B of U.S. imports take effect.
Wed 9/10	Adobe (ADBE) reports after close.
Thu 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS) — the print Fed Gov. Waller named as decisive for his Sept. vote.
Mon 9/14	Oracle (ORCL) reports after close.
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds ~50% coin flip (CME FedWatch, post-Waller Thu) vs. 65.9% Wed.
AI — [NEW]	OpenAI released GPT-6 Astra (9/3) to Daybreak-program business users — first model it says crossed its Preparedness Framework's "critical" cybersecurity threshold; wider ChatGPT/API rollout "in coming days."

No verified rocket launch or VC round of comparable scale fell inside this run's window; sub-bullet skipped.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:15A ET FRI 9/4 UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	\$95.25 (ICE settle, Thu) / no clean settle [unverified] , prior prints ~\$89-93
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	10Y 4.74-4.75% (Thu, -5/-6bp); 2Y ~4.35-4.39%, 30Y ~5.25-5.27% (Wed-Thu cluster) [Treasury.gov fetch

discarded]

DXY	98.99-99.37 [sources disagree] , fell sharply on Waller comments
S&P / Nasdaq futures	Dow E-mini -0.06%, S&P +0.04-0.06%, Nasdaq 100 +0.4-0.47% (premarket, ahead of jobs report)
VIX	opened 15.25 Thu (range 14.23-15.44), down from Tue's >16 close
S&P / Dow / Nasdaq	7,747.71 (+1.06%) / 53,686.11 (+1.18%, best day since Aug. 4) / 26,584.06 (+1.40%) — Thu close
Asia & Europe closes	Hang Seng 25,459 (Thu, +0.6%); Nikkei close not verified this run
Gold / retail gas	gold ~\$4,460-4,470 [unverified] ; gas \$4.1474/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/4)

Treasury.gov's daily par-yield-curve fetch this run returned a materially divergent 2Y/10Y reading vs. the market-quote cluster above and couldn't be reconciled — discarded rather than reported. Gold sourced only to a calculator site this run; flagged, not treated as a settle.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 187 (straits.live, since Feb. 28 declaration, as of 9/4)
Transits	Kpler: 4 vessels (9/4) vs. 10-day avg ~13-15 [dark-AIS undercounted]; PortWatch: stale , last Aug. 23 (4% of baseline)
Dark tankers	>80% dark-AIS share of remaining traffic; total flow ~40% of 2025 levels (straits.live, 9/3)
Strikes (24h)	none newly verified; Iran hit Jordan/Kuwait/UAE/Bahrain 9/2-9/3 (see Iran & Hormuz). Running total stale
War-risk premia	3-10% of hull value/transit (vs. ~0.25% pre-war), ~\$10-14M/VLCC voyage (trade press); straits.live ~40x pre-crisis

Kpler's near-real-time AIS counts, PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots, and trade-press per-voyage premium estimates measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	took Angels series 2-1 in Anaheim (W 7-3 Tue, L Wed, W 6-3/10 inn. Thu). Tampa Bay leads AL East 83-56
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(thru 9/2); Yankees/Red Sox hold two AL wild cards

[current record not verified this run]

Knicks

Josh Hart extension (4-yr/\$81M) still finalizing per his agents, unchanged since 9/2; other reports this week floated 3-yr/\$60-62M, unreconciled

Northwestern

off-season. Opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT

LEAD

FED SPLIT, JOBS REPORT NEXT

Waller breaks with Warsh, cutting September hike odds to a coin flip; markets rally on the split as today's jobs report becomes the next tiebreaker before Waller's own decisive data point

Thursday, Fed Governor Christopher Waller broke publicly with Chair Kevin Warsh's post-Jackson-Hole hawkish framing. In remarks prepared for a Reuters interview, Waller said that if disinflation continues in the data due over the next two weeks, "I would be inclined to support holding the target for the federal funds rate at its current setting" — paraphrasing John Lennon: "give disinflation a chance. We can wait one meeting." The reaction was immediate: CME FedWatch's implied probability of a 25bp hike at the Sept. 15-16 meeting collapsed from roughly 65.9% Wednesday to close to a coin flip — a swing one markets desk clocked at 12 percentage points "in minutes." That directly unwinds the trajectory set by Warsh's Aug. 28 Jackson Hole speech, which argued recent softer inflation readings "do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved" and had pushed hike odds from roughly 35% to 66.1% over the following days — the first public daylight between a Warsh-led FOMC majority and a sitting governor since the current hiking debate began.

Treasury yields and the dollar fell in tandem on the news — the 10-year eased to roughly 4.74-4.75% Thursday from as high as 4.79-4.80% earlier in the week, and DXY slid to the 98.99-99.37 area (sources disagree on the exact print) — while equities staged their best session in a month: the Dow gained roughly 600 points (+1.18%) to 53,686.11, its best day since Aug. 4; the S&P 500 rose 1.06% to 7,747.71; the Nasdaq Composite added 1.40% to 26,584.06. The VIX, which had closed above 16 Tuesday on the Iran escalation, opened Thursday at 15.25, in a 14.23-15.44 range.

Waller was explicit about what would change his mind: a hot August CPI print, due Sept. 11, that shows inflation trends aren't cooperating. That leaves today's August jobs report — due 8:30a ET, after this issue's press time — as the more immediate but less decisive input: a Dow Jones consensus calls for roughly +53,000 payrolls (other desks range as high as +90,000) against July's shock -23,000 miss, with the unemployment rate seen holding at 4.1%. *A print near consensus does little to resolve the Warsh-Waller split on its own — Waller himself pointed to the CPI print a week later as decisive — but a repeat of July's miss would hand the dovish faction fresh ammunition heading into the Sept. 15-16 meeting, while a strong beat hands it back to Warsh. Either way, what was a market pricing in Warsh's preference two weeks ago is now a genuine two-sided committee debate, and the next eight days carry two of the inputs that will settle it.*

Two more threads sit alongside this. Broadcom's fiscal Q3 print, released after Wednesday's close, beat cleanly — revenue \$29.6B (+86% Y/Y) against \$29.43B consensus, non-GAAP EPS \$3.32 (+96% Y/Y), AI-semiconductor revenue \$16.7B (+221% Y/Y, +54% Q/Q) — yet the stock fell 2.75% Thursday to \$357.16, with Q4 rev-

venue guidance of \$34.8B landing just under the Street's \$35.03B. After Nvidia's and Marvell's late-August prints cleared a low bar, Broadcom's guide-just-shy reaction reads as a sign the AI-capex trade now needs guidance that beats, not merely results that do. Separately, Wednesday-into-Thursday's Iran escalation — missile and drone attacks Iran claimed against U.S.-linked targets in Jordan, Kuwait, the UAE and Bahrain, each reported intercepted or without confirmed damage — drew a notably downbeat framing from Vice President Vance, who called the six-week exchange effectively over and said "I wouldn't call it a war." Brent nonetheless remains near six-week highs (see Iran & Hormuz), keeping an oil-driven upside risk to the very CPI print Waller just made decisive. A Fed newly split in public, a jobs report still outstanding, an AI-earnings bar that just moved higher, and a war both sides are describing as winding down while oil stays elevated — that is the set of crosscurrents this issue's reader carries onto the subway this morning.

POLITICS

House Speaker Mike Johnson has canceled floor votes for the final two weeks of September, leaving the House only a handful of session days before the midterms — meaning little floor action on spending, Iran-related authorization questions, or other pending business is likely before then. Trump has told House Republicans that losing the 2026 midterms would expose him to impeachment proceedings, according to a wire-syndicated account of his remarks to the conference. **[single-sourced, not independently confirmed this run]** Massachusetts' Markey-Moulton Senate primary (Markey won roughly 65%-35%, Aug. 31) and the stopgap funding bill signed into law through Dec. 11 both carry over unchanged from the prior issue. Colorado's 8th District Democratic primary, selecting an opponent

for GOP freshman Gabe Evans, remains the only primary left on this month's calendar.

ECONOMICS

Thursday's initial jobless claims (week ended Aug. 29) came in at 206,000, a touch above the 205,000 consensus and up 2,000 from the prior week's revised 204,000; the four-week average rose to 207,250. That reading is still roughly 30,000 below the year-ago week and shows no fresh deterioration at the weekly-claims level even as July's monthly payroll print showed an outright decline. Today's August jobs report (see Lead) is the next and more closely watched data point, but Waller has already named the Sept. 11 CPI print — not today's payrolls — as decisive for his own vote, a sequencing that puts unusual weight on two releases eight days apart bracketing the Sept. 15-16 FOMC meeting. Fed funds remain targeted at 3.50%-3.75%; a hike would take the range to 3.75%-4.00%.

BUSINESS

Amazon filed its first public response to the FTC and 22-state antitrust suit alleging the company secretly inflated Sponsored Products, Sponsored Brands and Sponsored Display auction prices via undisclosed "soft reserve" pricing, overcharging roughly 1.2 million advertisers by more than \$20B since 2019; Amazon called the suit a "fundamental[] misunderstand[ing]" of how its ad auctions work and said it presented no evidence of shopper harm, adding that average cost-per-click has stayed flat, inflation-adjusted, even as ad quality improved. Nvidia agreed to acquire Hugging Face for \$12.9B, a move industry observers framed as Nvidia pushing from chip supplier toward AI-platform company; against Nvidia's roughly

\$200B in projected calendar-year free cash flow, the deal was described as "not a big bite," and shares rose nearly 1% premarket on the news. Broadcom's beat-but-stock-fell reaction (see Lead) was the session's other major mover; no update on Apple's leadership transition or the Salesforce-Anthropic partnership surfaced this run.

TECHNOLOGY

OpenAI released GPT-6 Astra on Wednesday to business users in its Daybreak testing program, which the company says is the first model to cross its Preparedness Framework's "critical" cybersecurity threshold — a perfect score on ExploitBench and autonomous discovery and exploitation of two zero-days in internal tests; a wider rollout to ChatGPT Plus, Pro, Business and Enterprise users and the API is planned "in coming days." OpenAI is pairing the release with a \$1B "Daybreak for Frontline Defenders" program subsidizing cyber-defense access for critical-infrastructure operators. Anthropic is still targeting an IPO prospectus release after Labor Day and a public listing in late September or early October, per a report from The Information, building on June's confidential S-1 filing and its \$965B-valuation Series H. **[timeline reported, not confirmed]** OpenAI, Anthropic and SpaceXAI all reported service outages Thursday affecting model access; a cause wasn't specified in reporting located this run.

GEOPOLITICS

Russia struck Ukraine for a seventh consecutive night into Sept. 4, hitting Odesa and injuring at least 17 people, including three children, alongside continued strikes on Kyiv. Ukraine's Defense Forces struck back overnight, hitting a Russian landing craft, an electronic-warfare system and a UAV command post, while a naval unmanned surface vessel struck the support ship Nefrit in the Russian port of Sochi. Monitors describe Russia shifting toward faster, jet-powered attack drones and sustaining strikes around the clock rather than in the discrete nightly waves of prior months. Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar; no new movement on export controls surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond Tuesday's roughly 100-target CENTCOM strike and the first-ever direct U.S. hits on Iranian government tankers (see prior issue), Iran's retaliation continued into Wednesday and Thursday with missile and drone attacks it claimed against U.S.-linked sites in Jordan (13 missiles detected, 10 intercepted, 3 landing in remote areas), Kuwait (a drone strike sparked a residential-complex fire, since extinguished), the UAE and Bahrain; a U.S. official told CBS News the attacks didn't hit any military facility where U.S. forces are based. Vice President Vance called the six-week exchange effectively over, said "I wouldn't call it a war," and voiced skepticism of Iran's claim that a U.S. strike hit a wedding in Hormozgan Province — Iran says four were killed and roughly 35-50 wounded; CENTCOM disputes the claim. **[single-sourced to Iranian state media, disputed by CENTCOM, not independently confirmed]** Hormuz it-

self remains at Day 187 of closure per straits.live; Kpler counted just 4 vessels transiting as of Sept. 4 against a 10-day average of roughly 13-15, with dark-AIS share above 80% of remaining traffic and total flow near 40% of 2025 levels; PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshot wasn't refreshed past Aug. 23 (4% of baseline) this run. War-risk premia are quoted at 3-10% of hull value per transit versus roughly 0.25% pre-war — on the order of \$10-14M per VLCC voyage by trade-press estimates — with straits.live citing about 40x pre-crisis on its latest read; these vendor figures track different things over different windows and, per standing policy, are never netted or averaged against one another.

SPORTS

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Northwestern	off-season. Opens Sat 9/5 vs. South Dakota State, 7p CT

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 9/2: Apple's CEO transition (Ternus, complete); the funding bill (signed, no movement); the Markey-Moulton primary (resolved). Watching: today's jobs report against the Warsh-Waller split; the Sept. 11 CPI print Waller named as decisive; whether Iran's Jordan/Kuwait/UAE/Bahrain strikes draw further U.S. response; Amazon's formal court filing; Anthropic's S-1 release; the Nvidia-Hugging Face deal; GPT-6 Astra's wider rollout.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.